

Blackout Poetry

Name: _____

A poem is hiding on this page. Find it.

Circle the words you want to keep, in order. Black out everything else. Give your poem a title.

Example: The **rain** had been falling since breakfast, **soft** and grey, and the whole **street** seemed to be **holding its breath**, **waiting** for something to happen.

becomes: rain / soft / street / holding its breath / waiting

By twenty past three on a Friday, the school begins to forget itself. The corridors, which have been shouting all week, lower their voices. Chairs are tipped onto desks like sleeping animals. Somewhere a door bangs, and the sound rolls down the stairs and out into the yard, where the afternoon light lies across the netball court like a warm gold blanket.

Teachers walk more slowly now. One of them is humming. The photocopier, exhausted after five days of work, clicks once and goes silent. In the empty art room a single painting is drying by the window: a blue boat on a green sea, with a sun that someone forgot to finish.

Outside the gates the buses wait with their engines running, breathing out small clouds of heat. Students spill across the pavement in twos and threes, laughing at nothing, bags swinging, ties already loosened, already half somewhere else. Someone shouts a name. Someone else shouts it back.

And the weekend, which has been waiting patiently all week behind the hills, comes rolling down the road towards them, bright and enormous, with its pockets full of time.

